

US Communications Infrastructure

Equinix, Inc.

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

 **EQIX**

1,270.00 USD

5 October 2026

Estimate Change



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Equinix (EQIX) 3Q26 Preview: Inter-connecting the dots

The EQIX team has been busy at conferences and messaging into the Q3 print; we spoke with them last week for a general update. We expect EQIX's 3Q26 results to be positive and largely expected, with potential upside from delivery acceleration. Anticipated upside from pricing actions and leasing activity are more likely to emerge in 4Q26 or early FY27.

Interconnect + Fabric One: We notoriously love [EQIX's interconnection moat](#) and are not alone in thinking its undermonetized today. The company is discussing shifting the pricing strategy, but reportedly still experimenting with options. We're unlikely to see anything in the numbers yet beyond the consistent cross-connect count growth. [Fabric One](#) was recently rolled out with the goal of simplifying and accelerating network provisioning... this builds on the interconnect moat and could create a strong, high-margin flywheel. But again, probably not yet.

Cabinet delivery and bookings: Per EQIX's delivery schedule, the company is set to deliver >5k cabinets in Q3 and ~14k in Q4. EQIX pulled in deliveries last quarter and, in our opinion, is likely to do so again. While there should be a corresponding bump to bookings numbers, it will be muted - EQIX is holding to their mid-20% yield targets by relying on phased lease-ups (avg. ramp of 2-3 years). We're excited to see cabinets being delivered faster, especially in a world where much data center construction is facing delays, but think investors will need to practise some patience before the bookings and revenue accelerate.

Pricing and renewal spreads: As we write consistently, the pricing environment for any data center capacity, let alone top-tier metro capacity, is extremely attractive. Though EQIX has historically been conservative about price-ups and renewal spreads, it sounds like they may be reexamining that strategy in today's market. This could be more attractive and happen faster than investors think... much of the base is on auto-renew, which defaults to ~3% CPI-like escalators... but those auto-renew contracts are largely on a one-year term.

We believe the proactive Available-to-Renew (ATR) program could deliver an opportunity to raise pricing and bump margins, especially if much of the base is on even shorter-term contracts. We would happily take higher churn numbers in exchange for a base re-rating... but probably again not this quarter. Perhaps early indicators with a bit more progress in Q4.

Continued on 2nd page...

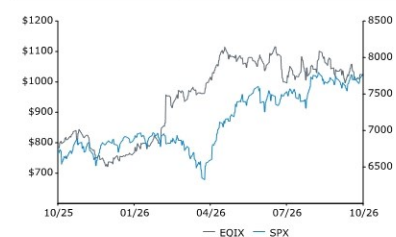
Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
EQIX (USD)	14.96	17.12	20.13	EBITDA (M)	3,914	4,697	5,570	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	68.4	59.8	50.8
OLD	--	17.79	20.87						EV/EBITDA (x)	31.2	26.0	21.9

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	5 Oct 2026
EQIX Close Price (USD)	1,023.44
Price Target (USD)	1,270.00
Upside/(Downside)	24%
52-Week Range	1,128.68/720.62
SPX	7,773.95
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	2.0%
Market Cap (USD) (M)	100,985
EV (USD) (M)	122,133
Performance	YTD 1M 6M 12M
Absolute (%)	33.6 (1.2) 2.3 31.4
SPX (%)	13.6 0.7 18.1 15.8
Relative (%)	20.0 (1.9) (15.8) 15.7

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



xScale: We were lukewarm on the xScale business [in our initiation](#), positing that it's a more competitive space where EQIX is far less advantaged relative to its dominance in its core enterprise colo business. Commentary at conferences suggests the company somewhat agrees with this stance... xScale's earnings will be lumpy and hard to forecast, often acting as "gravity" in the form of NRR. We had some earlier this year with the Hampton campus, but given our facility tracking, we don't anticipate much for Q3. Both Hampton and Minooka seem to be on track and will contribute in 2028+.

We expect 3Q results to be on the upper end of guidance, with perhaps a mild raise through the end of the year. While we believe that there could be potential upside to consensus from delivery acceleration, pricing action, or leasing activity, we expect these catalysts to emerge in 4Q or even early FY27. Looking ahead, we will watch for more capacity pull-forward, improved renewal pricing and monetization of bundled interconnection and Fabric services, as well as incremental commentary on the timing, magnitude, and any evolving commentary on xScale. **We remain OP; PT \$1,270.**

Investment Implications

We value EQIX on a Price to Adjusted Funds From Operations (AFFO) multiple. Our \$1,270 price target is based on ~25x NTM+1 AFFO of \$5.04B (prev \$5.05B).

DETAILS

EXHIBIT 1: EQIX FY26 Guidance

FY26 Guidance				
	Midpoint	Midpoint	Consensus	Estimate
	Given 2Q26	Given 1Q26	FY 2026	FY 2026
Revenue	10,245	10,239	10,281	10,287
Adj. EBITDA	\$5,240	\$5,221	\$5,270	\$5,272
<i>Adj. EBITDA Margin</i>	51.1%	51.0%	51.3%	51.2%
Recurring CapEx	300	292	275	336
Non-Recurring CapEx	5,200	3,990	4,537	5,219
AFFO	4,270	4,273	4,296	4,277
AFFO per share	\$42.99	\$43.04	\$43.29	\$43.46

Source: Company Filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

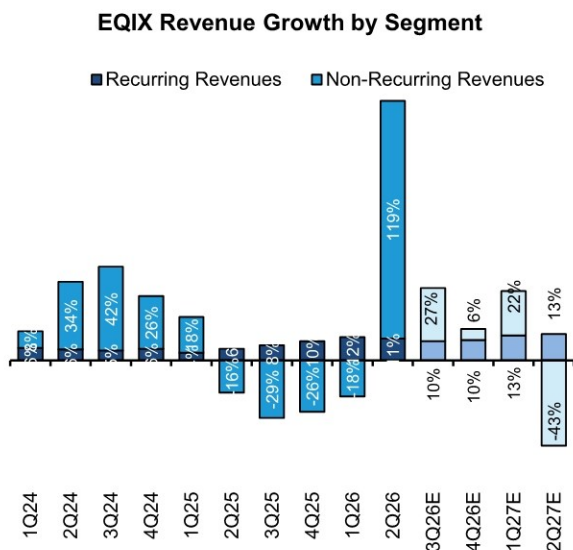
EXHIBIT 2: EQIX Long Term Guidance

Long Term 2027-2029 Guidance				
	Prior Outlook		Updated Outlook	
	June 2025 Analyst Day	Midpoint	2Q26	Midpoint
Total Revenue Growth (Annual Range)	7% - 10%	9%	10% - 13%	12%
Adjusted EBITDA Margin (in 2029)	52%+	52%+	53%+	53%+
Total Capital Expenditures (Annual Range)	\$3 - \$4B	\$3.5B	\$5 - \$7B	\$6.0B
AFFO per Share Growth (Annual Range)	5% - 9%	7%	9% - 12%	11%
Dividend per Share Growth (Annual Range)	8%+	8%+	Approximately AFFO per Share Growth	11%
Net Leverage Ratio (in 2029)	In-line with Current Investment Grade Ratings		In-line with Current Investment Grade Ratings	

CAPEX Excludes M&A activity, real estate acquisitions and xScale

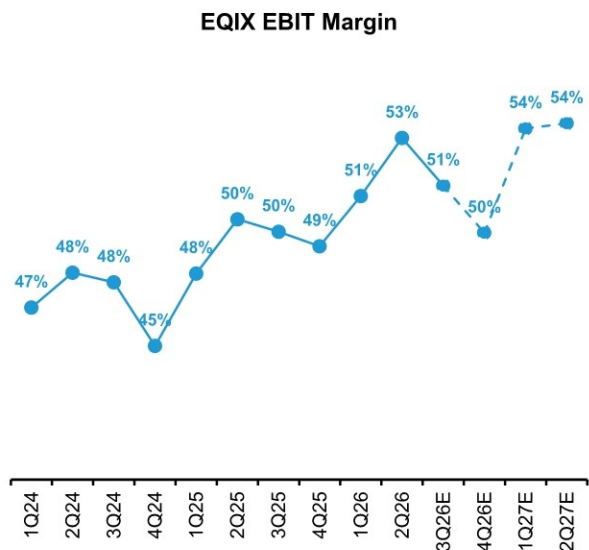
Source: Company Filings, Bernstein Analysis

EXHIBIT 3: **EQIX Revenue YoY Growth by Segment (%)**



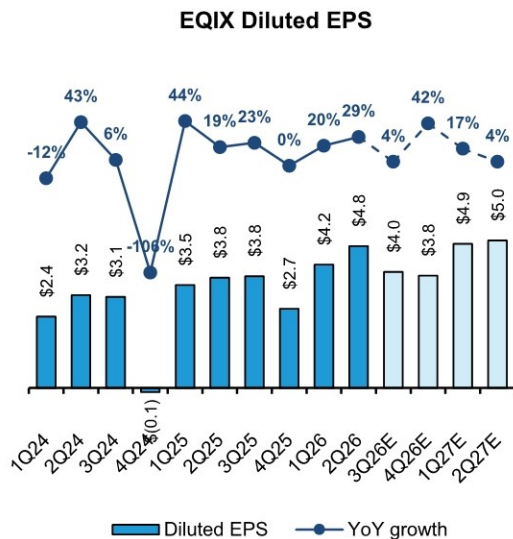
2Q26 increase was driven by elevated xScale closings (Hampton)
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 4: **EQIX EBIT Margin**



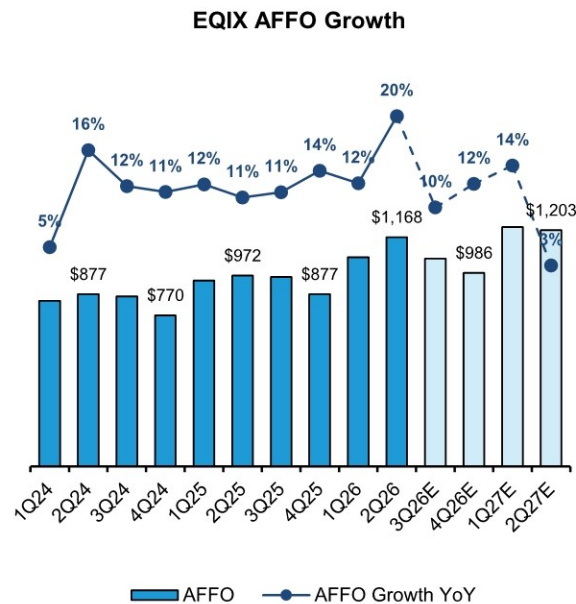
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 5: **EQIX Diluted EPS (\$, %)**



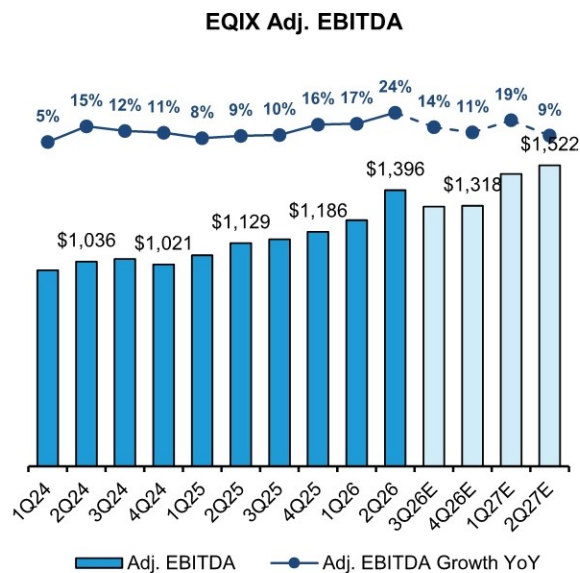
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 6: **EQIX AFFO YoY Growth (\$M, %)**



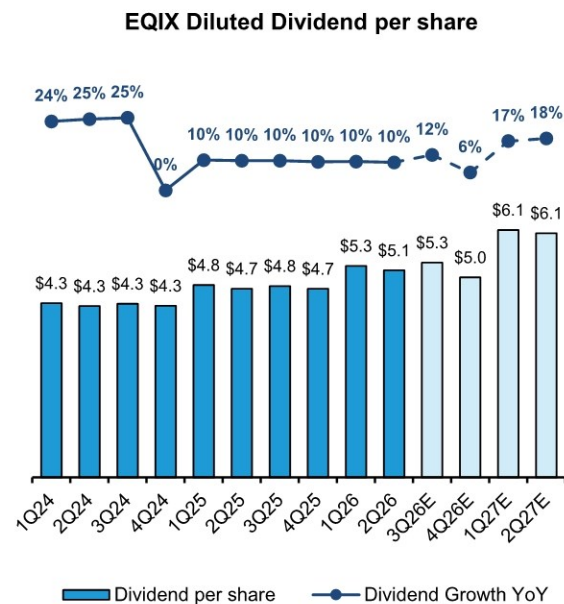
2Q26 AFFO YoY growth was driven by higher net income from elevated xScale (Hampton) closings
Source: Company Filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 7: **EQIX Adj. EBITDA YoY Growth (\$M, %)**



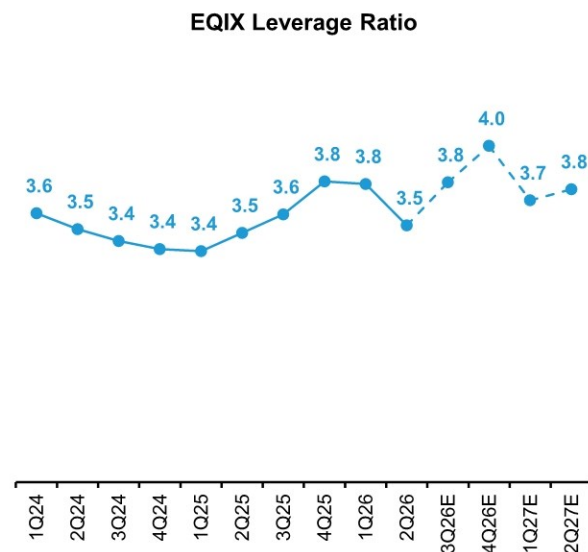
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 8: **EQIX Diluted Dividend per share (\$, %)**



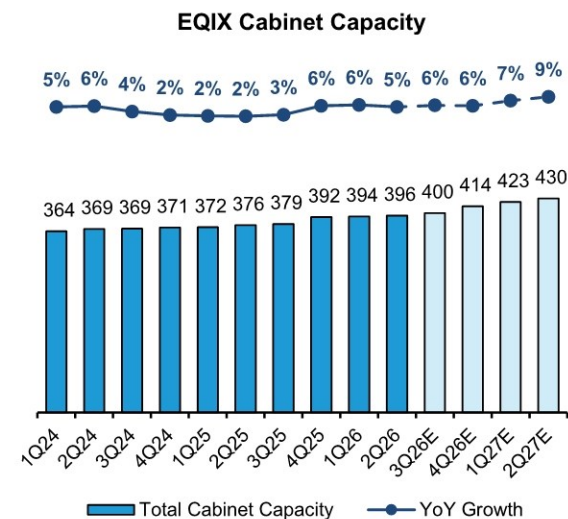
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 9: **EQIX Leverage Ratio**



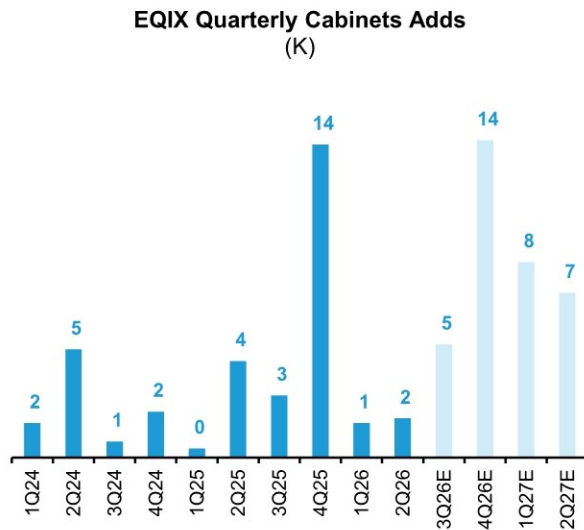
Calculates as Net debt including fin leases and Q Annualized Adj. EBITDA
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 10: **EQIX Cabinet Capacity (k, %)**



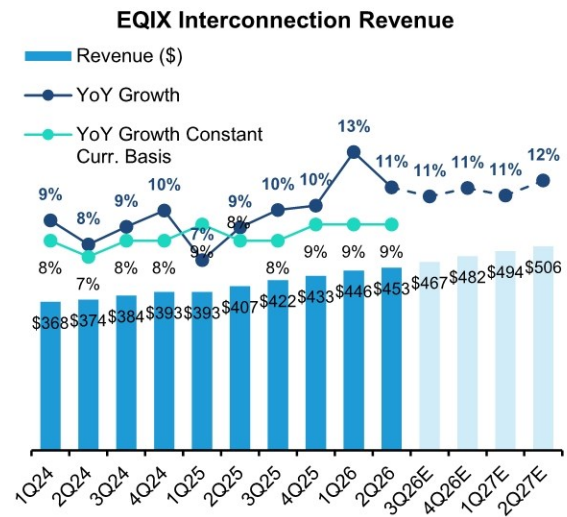
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 11: **EQIX Quarterly Cabinets Adds (K)**



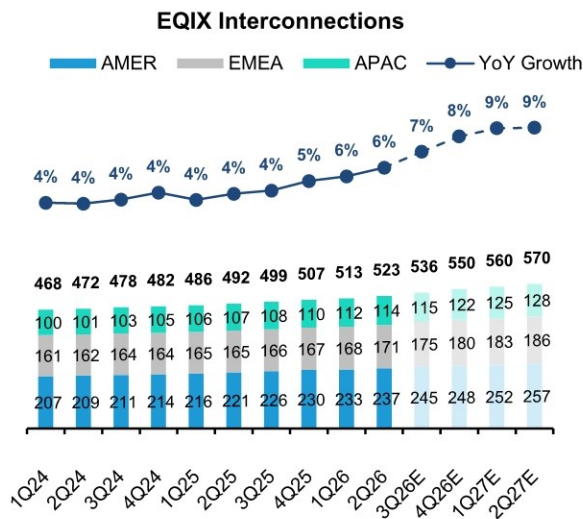
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 12: **EQIX Interconnection Overview (K, %)**



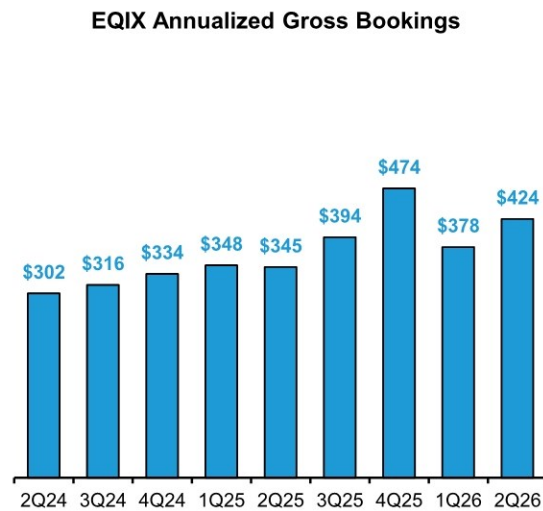
Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 13: **EQIX Interconnections**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

EXHIBIT 14: **EQIX Annualized Gross Bookings (\$M)**



Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 15: EQIX Income Statement Overview

All values in millions, except per share data

	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E	1Q27E	2Q27E		FY 2025	FY 2026	FY 2027	FY 2028	FY 2029
Recurring Revenues	2,215	2,294	2,331	2,377	2,430	2,528	2,623	2,691		8,739	9,665	10,915	12,264	13,803
Non-Recurring Revenues	101	126	113	248	128	133	138	142		478	622	575	646	727
Total Revenues	2,316	2,420	2,444	2,625	2,558	2,661	2,761	2,832		9,217	10,287	11,490	12,910	14,531
Cost of revenues	1,142	1,198	1,186	1,230	1,285	1,374	1,329	1,360		4,508	5,075	5,518	6,173	6,883
Gross profit	1,174	1,222	1,258	1,395	1,273	1,287	1,432	1,472		4,709	5,212	5,973	6,737	7,647
Total operating expenses	700	800	681	730	706	727	750	764		2,861	2,843	3,095	3,456	3,890
Income from operations	474	422	577	665	567	560	682	708		1,848	2,369	2,877	3,281	3,758
Income before income taxes	399	312	471	523	435	420	525	538		1,508	1,848	2,156	2,295	2,489
Income tax expense	(25)	(48)	(56)	(46)	(54)	(52)	(66)	(67)		(160)	(209)	(269)	(287)	(311)
xScale contribution to Net income	-	-	-	-	12	12	27	27		-	24	110	214	366
Net income	374	264	415	477	392	379	487	498		1,348	1,663	1,996	2,223	2,544
Net (income) / loss attributable to non-controlling interests	-	1	-	2	-	-	-	-		2	2	-	-	-
Net income attributable to common stockholders	374	265	415	479	392	379	487	498		1,350	1,665	1,996	2,223	2,544
(+) Adjustments	11	85	(4)	29	-	-	-	-		118	25	-	-	-
Adjusted Net Income	385	350	411	508	392	379	487	498		1,468	1,690	1,996	2,223	2,544
Earnings per share (EPS)														
EPS (basic)	3.82	2.70	4.22	4.86	3.98	3.85	4.93	5.05		13.79	16.92	20.24	22.54	25.79
EPS (diluted)	3.81	2.69	4.20	4.83	3.96	3.83	4.91	5.03		13.76	16.86	20.13	22.42	25.66
Adjusted EPS (diluted)	3.92	3.56	4.16	5.12	3.96	3.83	4.91	5.03		14.96	17.12	20.13	22.42	25.66
Adjusted FFO (AFFO) per share (basic)	9.85	8.93	10.82	11.84	10.73	9.99	12.36	12.20		38.42	43.46	48.11	54.15	60.19

Source: Company filings, Bernstein Analysis and Estimates

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	5 Oct 2026		TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing Price	Price Target		Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
EQIX (Equinix)	O	USD	1,023.44	1,270.00	15.7%	USD	14.96	17.12	20.13	68.4	59.8	50.8
OLD								17.79	20.87			
SPX			7,773.95									

ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD
O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**Equinix, Inc.**

We value EQIX on a forward Price-to-Adjusted Funds From Operations (AFFO) multiple. Our \$1,270 price target is based on ~25x NTM+1 AFFO of \$5.04B.

RISKS**Equinix, Inc.**

The main downside risks to our price target/Outperform rating on EQIX are 1) Slowdown in enterprise demand for data center capacity, 2) Increased competition in the interconnection space, and 3) Continuing decline in market share of data center supply may elevate pricing pressures

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The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

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Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

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- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 10 pp
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- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

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- **Credit Underperform (C-UP):** The total return of the Reference Credit Instrument is expected to underperform the credit spread of bonds of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous credit ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

A list of all investment recommendations produced by the author(s) of this report alongside credit ratings history are available upon request.

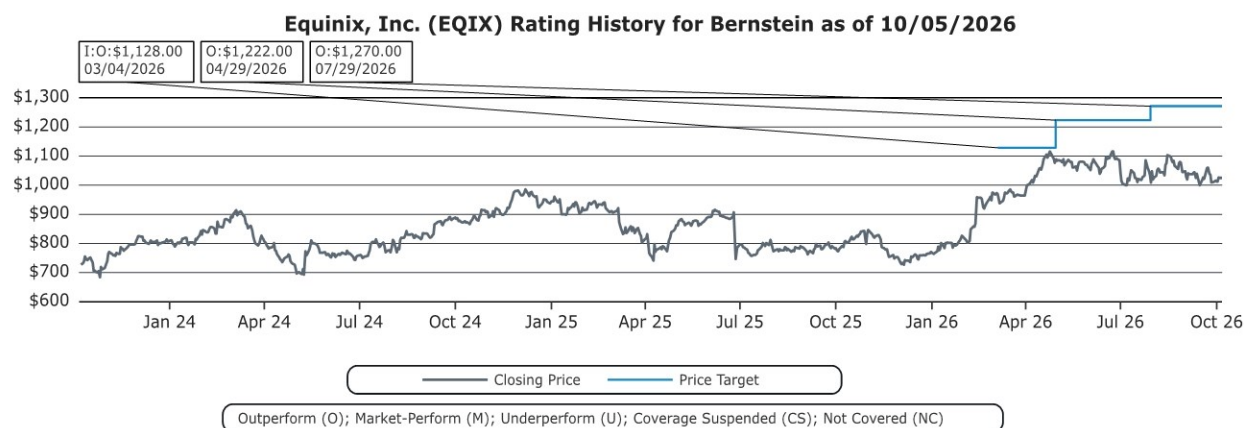
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Equity Rating	Market Abuse Regulation (MAR) and FINRA Rating Category	Global Rating Distribution	Investment Banking Relationships*
Outperform	BUY	52.3%	14.2%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months. As of September 30, 2026. All figures are updated quarterly.

PRICE CHARTS / RATINGS AND PRICE TARGET HISTORY



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